

Total number of printed pages-11

36 (SEM-II) HS 121

2026

ENGLISH

Paper : HS-121

Full Marks : 100

Time : Three hours

***The figures in the margin indicate
full marks for the questions.***

- I. Read the text below carefully :

The Battle of Marathon

The victory of the small Greek democracy of Athens over the mighty Persian Empire in 490 B.C. is one of the most famous events in history. Darius, king of the Persian Empire, was furious because Athens had interceded for the other Greek city-states in revolt against Persian domination. In anger the king sent an enormous army to defeat Athens. He thought it would take drastic steps to pacify the rebellious part of the empire.

Persia was ruled by one man. In Athens, however, all citizens helped to rule. Ennobled by this participation, Athenians were prepared to die for their city-state. Perhaps this was the secret of the remarkable victory at Marathon, which freed them from Persian rule. On their way to Marathon, the Persians tried to fool some Greek city-states by claiming to have come in peace. The frightened citizens of Delos refused to believe this. Not wanting to abet the conquest of Greece, they fled from their city and did not return until the Persians had left. They were wise, for the Persians next conquered the city of Eritrea and captured its people.

Tiny Athens stood alone against Persia. The Athenian people went to their sanctuaries. There they prayed for deliverance. They asked their gods to expedite their victory. The Athenians refurbished their weapons and moved to the plain of Marathon, where their little band would meet the Persians. At the last moment, soldiers from Plataea reinforced the Athenian troops.

The Athenian army attacked, and Greek citizens fought bravely. The power of the mighty Persians was offset by the love that the Athenians had for their city. Athenians

defeated the Persians in both archery and hand combat. Greek soldiers seized Persian ships and burned them, and the Persians fled in terror. Herodotus, a famous historian, reports that 6,400 Persians died, compared to only 192 Athenians.

- ✓ 1. Based on your reading and understanding of the text, make notes using **any one** of the following note-taking methods : 10

- (a) Linear
- (b) Clustering
- (b) Cornell

2. ✓ Write a summary of the passage in about **80** to **100** words. 5

- II. Read the text given below carefully and answer the questions that follow :

From Challenges to the Cosmos

Stephen Hawking was an English scientist, cosmologist, teacher and author. He used a wheelchair to move around and a computer with a voice synthesizer to talk, after being diagnosed with a degenerative motor neurone disease called ALS when he was at university. He is best known for discovering

how the universe was formed and predicting what might happen to it in the future. Stephen William Hawking was born on 8th January 1942 in Oxford, England. He was born exactly 300 years after the death of the famous astronomer Galileo — a fact that Stephen was very proud of. He was the eldest child of Frank Hawking, a medical researcher, and Isobel Walker, a Scottish secretary. His parents loved learning and both went to the University of Oxford. His father studied medicine, while his mother studied philosophy and politics.

Stephen was born during the Second World War. At this time, London was a very dangerous place. To make sure that Stephen would be safe when he was born, his mother moved from their home in Highgate, London to Oxford. During the time that they lived in Oxford, Hawking's parents had more children so he gained three siblings: two sisters named Philippa and Mary and an adopted brother named Edward.

In 1950, the Hawking family moved to St. Albans in Hertfordshire. People who knew the family thought that they were rather odd; instead of talking or watching television,

the family would sit in silence and each read a book while they ate meals. They are said to have kept a beehive in their basement and made fireworks in their greenhouse! From an early age, Stephen showed an interest in science, especially space. He loved to lie on the grass in the garden and watch the stars with his mother. Stephen enjoyed playing board games and making model aeroplanes and boats. With the help of his maths teacher, Stephen built a computer out of old clock and telephone parts at just 16 years old.

Just like his parents, Stephen went to the University of Oxford at just 17 years old, passing his exams a year early. He was said to find the work 'ridiculously easy' and he received the highest award possible for his degree in natural sciences. Stephen then moved on to study at the University of Cambridge. While he was there, Stephen studied black holes. At the time, people thought that black holes were places in space where gravity pulls so much that even light cannot get out. Yet, Stephen discovered that one thing could escape from a black hole: radiation. This type of radiation, now

known as Hawking radiation, was named after him and, using what he had learned, Stephen helped to prove the idea that the universe began with the Big Bang. Stephen's work, along with his incredible sense of humour, inspired millions of people to become interested in science.

A. Scan the text and fill in the blanks :
1×5=5

1. Stephen Hawking's father was a _____ and his mother was a _____.
2. Stephen built a computer out of _____ and _____ at just 16 years old.
3. Hawking was diagnosed with a disease called _____.

B. ✓ Skim the text and state whether the following statements are True **or** False :

1×5=5

1. The Hawking family moved to St. Albans in 1954.
2. Stephen Hawking was very proud of the fact that he was born exactly 400 years after the death of the famous astronomer Galileo.

3. Stephen went to the University of Oxford at just 16 years old.
4. Stephen discovered that radiation could escape from a black hole.
5. Hawking had an adopted brother named Edward.

C Find words from the passage that mean the same as the following : $1 \times 5 = 5$

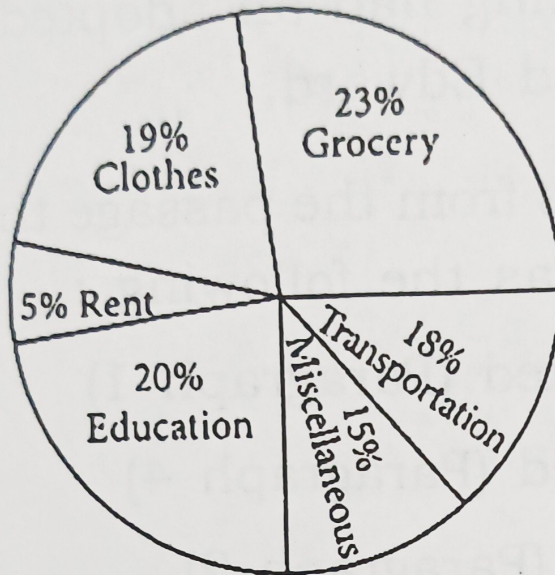
1. detected (Paragraph 1)
2. started (Paragraph 4)
3. risky (Paragraph 2)
4. insanely (Paragraph 4)
5. quietness (Paragraph 3)

D Scan the text and match the information given below : $1 \times 5 = 5$

Column A	Column B
1. St. Albans is in	(a) Cambridge University
2. Hawking's mother studied	(b) during the Second World War
3. Stephen enjoyed making	(c) Hertfordshire
4. He studied black holes at	(d) politics
5. Stephen Hawking was born	(e) boats

- III. The given pie chart represents the amount of money spent by a family on different items in a month. Write a paragraph commenting on the given data in about **80** to **100** words :

5



(Source: Survey Council)

- IV. Write a Descriptive Passage on **any one** of the titles given below in about **180** to **200** words :

10

(a) The Room of Lost Memories

(b) Fading Photographs

(d) The Stairway

(d) The Fragrance of Rain

- V. Write an email applying for the position of Marketing Executive at Trimph Pvt. Ltd.

10

VI. Find the abbreviations in the given sentences and write their full forms :

1. N.B. HR wants the reports asap. 3
2. The failure rate among ICT projects in HE reaches 40 percent (Smith et al., 2008). 3
3. The WHO is working to eliminate malaria worldwide. 1
4. Re. the farewell party next week: everyone is required to pay ₹ 1K to the CR by tomorrow. 3

VII. Complete the following text using a/an/the (or nothing) in each gap : $1 \times 10 = 10$

In recent years, (a) _____ rapid development of technology has led to (b) _____ emergence of artificial intelligence as (c) _____ powerful tool in various fields. Researchers believe that AI is not just (d) _____ passing trend, but (e) _____ beginning of a new era.

Many experts argue that (f) _____ AI will transform industries such as healthcare, education, and finance, making them more

efficient. However, there is also (g) _____ ongoing debate about (h) _____ ethical implications of AI and its impact on employment. While some see it as (i) _____ opportunity for growth, others view it as (j) _____ potential threat to human jobs.

VIII. Edit the following sentences to eliminate ✓ problems with Subject-Verb Agreement and write the edited sentence. If a sentence is correct, write 'correct' : $1 \times 10 = 10$

1. The list of items are on the table.
2. Each of the players have a unique skill.
3. The teacher, along with the students, are going on a trip.
4. Neither of the answers are correct.
5. A bouquet of roses smell wonderful.
6. The news is very surprising today.
7. One of my friends live in Cleveland.
8. Biryani and raita are my favourite dish.
9. Everyone in the class have completed their homework.
10. Mathematics is my favourite subject.

IX. Identify if the speaker in the following expressions is showing agreement or disagreement : 1×10=10

Expression	To express.....
1. I'm afraid I don't share your view.	
2. That's exactly what I was thinking.	
3. I see your point, but I disagree.	
4. You're absolutely right about that.	
5. I'm not convinced this is the best option.	
6. I couldn't agree with you more.	
7. I beg to differ on that matter.	
8. That makes perfect sense to me.	
9. I'm not so sure I agree with that idea.	
10. Yes, that's a good point.	